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The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388 T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR

MAY			JUNE		
6	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	3	Juniors Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
7	Sat. Boursette & Library Day, Bldg #6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am	4	Sat. Boursette & Library Day, Bldg #6 - Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:30 am
13	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	10	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
20	Juniors Program: "Zeppelins" by Stephen Mabie	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	17	SUMMER PICNIC - Fireside Room	6:00 pm
27	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm	27	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:30 pm
30	MEMORIAL DAY		20	Summer Solstice	

7/01 - No Meeting - Independence Day; 7/08 - Show & Tell; 7/09 - Sat. Boursette; 7/15 - Auction; 7/22 - Program; 7/29-Bourse;

US #4822a,4823a,4988

US #3410e

Editor's Corner

Memorial Day was originally called Decoration Day, and was initiated to honor the soldiers for the Union and Confederate armies who died during the American Civil War. Celebrations honoring Civil War heroes started the year after the war ended. The establishment of a public holiday was meant to unify the celebration as a national day of remembrance instead of a holiday celebrated separately by the Union and Confederate states. By the late 19th century, the holiday became known as Memorial Day and was expanded to include the deceased veterans of all the wars fought by American forces. In 1971, Memorial Day became a federal holiday, and was given the floating date of the last Monday in May.

'Solstice' (Latin: 'solstitium') means 'sun-stopping'. The point on the horizon where the sun appears to rise and set, stops and reverses direction after this day. Every year there are two solstices, one in June, when the sun is directly over the Tropic of Cancer, and one in December, when the sun is directly over the Tropic of Capricorn.

The June solstice reaches its northernmost point as the Earth's North Pole tilts directly towards the sun, at about 23.4 degrees. It is the longest day and shortest night of the year in the Northern Hemisphere. Meanwhile, the June solstice brings the shortest day and longest night south of the equator.

June Solstice in San Antonio, Texas, USA is on Monday, June 20, 2016 at 5:34 PM CDT

Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta

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Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
Philatex Editors
334 Olney Dr.
San Antonio, Tx 78209
Or email either of us.
lys@satx.rr.com dora.roberts@hotmail.com

Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1, facing Nacogdoches Rd.
Yearly dues are $20.00, prorated.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
Vice President:	Robin Ellis
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
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Communications Chair:	George Garten
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneers:	Chip Swinney
	Jim Wallace
Librarian:	Pat Richmond

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Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Dr. Eric Shepherd
APS Circuit Books	Dr. Eric Shepherd

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourses and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

While your purchases will be given to you during the auction, please wait until the end of the auction to pay for them. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks made out to S.A.P.A. are acceptable. Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

President's Message

It's been a busy week for me. A couple of meetings and the San Antonio Orchid Show last weekend. I was really tired Sat when I got home but was happy to find in the mail a special preview of the World Stamp Show put out by Linn's Stamp News. I spent the next two hours reading it cover to cover and marking all the things I want to see. In addition to the 200 dealers and 4100 frames, some of the highlights in the Court of Honor will be the British Guiana 1856 1c Magenta, full sheets of Great Britian's Penny Black and Two Penny Blue, and several examples of the 1918 Inverted Jenny. Several new books will also be available for sale such as the new second edition of the *Encyclopedia of United States Stamps and Stamp Collecting* put out by the US Stamp Society. I plan to take lots of pictures and will present a report to the club when I return.

Dr. Eric Shepherd *May 2016*

SAPA SUMMER PICNIC

This year our annual summer picnic is on June 17th. Tickets can be purchased in advance from Pat Richmond or Fred Groth for $7, and will be $8 at the door. This year the picnic will be at our usual meeting place in the Fireside Room at MacArthur Park Lutheran Church, starting at 6:00pm. Bring a salad, side dish, or dessert to go with the wonderful barbecue from Barbecue Station.

PROGRAM NOTES 2016

APR 15 - "Zeppelin Stamps" by Steve Mabie To borrow a phrase from Charles Dickens, "It was the best of times and the worst of times…." The beginning of the 1930s was a time of world-wide depression, but also a time of excitement driven by technology advances. "Art Deco" was the style of the moment and the Zeppelin fit to a "tee".

Sleek and aerodynamic, the zeppelins provided a new, safe way to travel as well as a safe, rapid means for delivering mail to distant ports of call!!! Led by Germany with the Graf Zeppelin and later with the Hindenburg, zeppelins captured the imagination of the entire world. This was documented in the world's postage stamps of the era.

Steve Mabie will present his collection of Zeppelin postage stamps and covers. I personally am looking forward to Steve's presentation and I trust you will also. Well, Steve, the ball is now in your court!!!

Yours in Philately, Pat Richmond

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES 2016

MAY 7-8 TSDA SAN ANTONIO STAMP SHOW Norris Conference Center, 618 NW Freeway Loop 410, Suite 207, in Park North, San Antonio, Tx 78216. **Hours: Saturday 10am-5pm, Sunday 10am-3pm.**

MAY 20-21 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP SHOW Crowne Plaza Hotel, 7611 Katy Freeway (IH-10 West), Houston, Tx, 77024. **Hours: Friday 10am-5pm, Saturday 9am-4pm.**

JUNE 24-25 TSDA DALLAS STAMP SHOW Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho, Richardson, TX 75080. **Hours: Friday 11am-5 pm, Saturday 9am-4pm.**

May Days Special

From May 1st to May 31st, all SAPA club members will receive 10% off all Showgard mounts and stockbooks.

Remember—Gift Certificates are available and make great holiday presents for philatelists!

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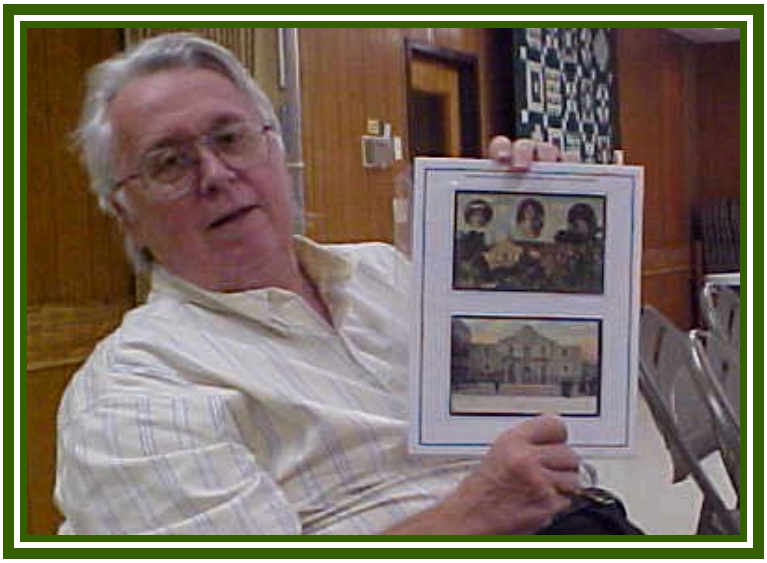
ABC Stamps is located on the corner of Broadway and Terrell Rd, across from La Madeleine. It is at the side of the building facing Terrell Rd. Parking is in the rear, or behind La Madeleine.



"The San Antonio Missions: The New World Heritage Sites"

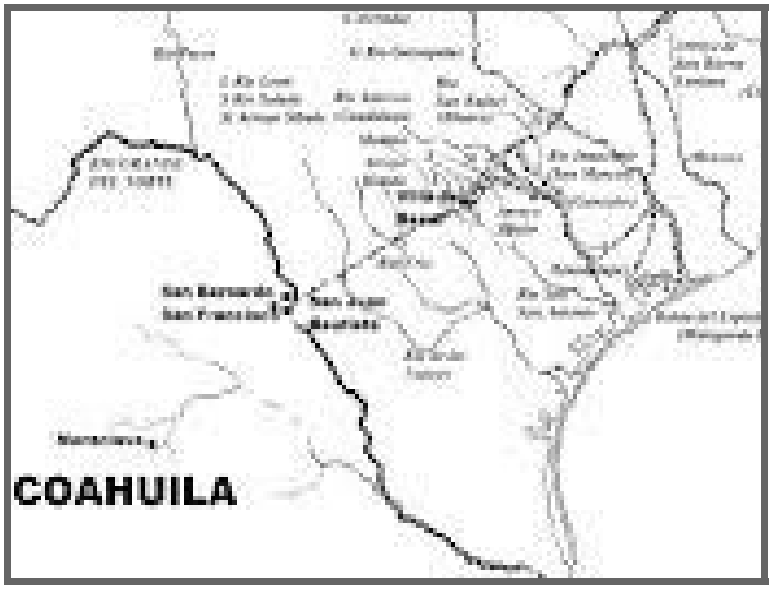
By Dr. Eric Shepard February 19, 2016

Dr. Eric Shepherd gave us a detailed history of the missions in San Antonio, Texas-the original sites and the general history of the churches which were established in San Antonio. The missions were built by the Spaniards to extend their control into the new world. They were suppose to be self-sustaining.

In 1691, two Spanish priests traveled to the San Antonio River. They named the place San Antonio de Padua—the Indians called it Yanaguana. ↓

In 1709 two Franciscan Friars were given permission to contact the Tejas Indians and establish the San Antonio missions at the head of the San Antonio River.

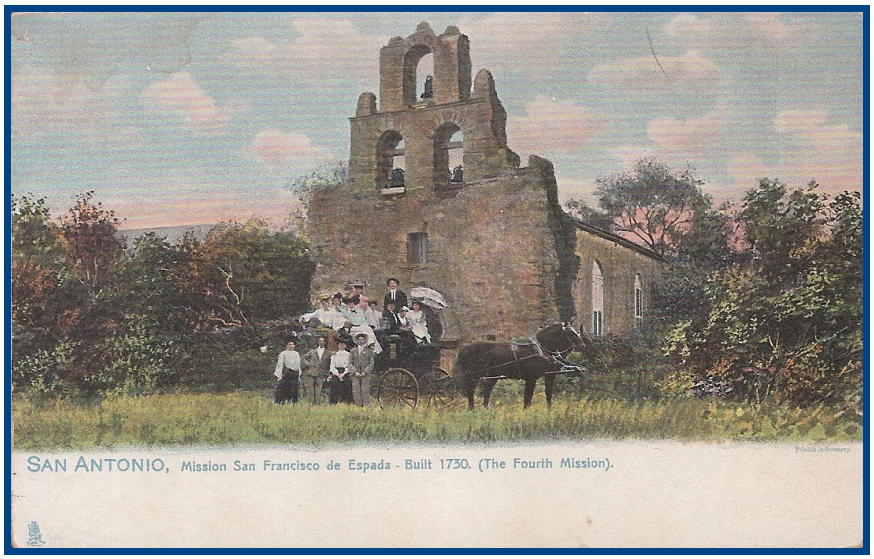
In 1718, a second Expedition went to the head of the San Antonio, River at the San Pedro Springs and Governor Martin de la Alarcon officially established Mission de la Valero. ↓



Originally the mission was to be self-sustaining. It was named "The Alamo". During the next 40 years, a series of epidemics depopularized it. In 1793, it was secularized.

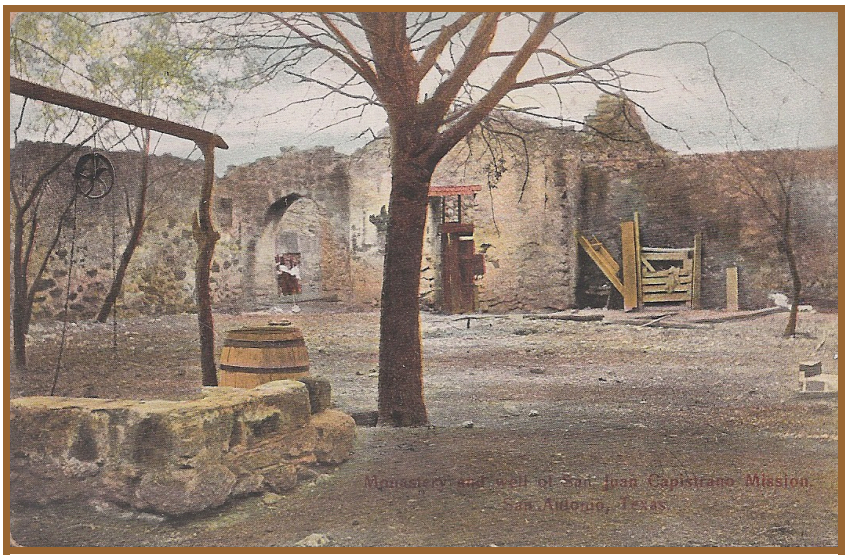
There are two possible origins for the name. Alamo in Spanish means "cottonwood" and there were many cottonwood trees around. Secondly it could have been named for the troop of cavalry from El Alamo in Mexico. They were "The Flying Company of the Jose y Santiago del Alamo der Parres" and it was later shortened to Alamo.

Dr. Eric showed us a small portion of his postcard collection. I was especially impressed with the one shown at right. ➜



Every year wedding parties like to have their pictures made with the backdrop of the missions.

San Juan Capistrano was left a mess—but, it has been restored and established as one of the most visited missions in the New Heritage sites.



Dr. Eric's program was well attended by the stamp club. It was appreciated by everyone who attended.

Well, Dr. Eric, you have done it again!!! Every time you give a program, it is interesting, informative and entertaining!!! Of course, it would have been nice to have vanilla ice cream—but we can't have everything, can we???

We have an empty slot in February 2017—start planning!!!

Yours in Philately, Patricia Richmond

Linn's Stamp NEWS SCOTT

Buying stamps can be an ordeal at San Antonio post office

April 04, 2016 01:40 PM

By Bill McAllister, Washington Correspondent

Buying stamps at the post office in the Hipolito F. Garcia Federal Building and U.S. Courthouse in San Antonio, Texas, is no simple task. You must pass through a detailed security review to gain access to the stamp counter. Many customers in the area are buying their stamps elsewhere to avoid the inconvenience. Image courtesy of PMCC.

When Postmaster General James Farley went to San Antonio in 1937 to dedicate the Texas city's new post office and federal building, he used the event to plug stamp collecting.

"You'll find it a lot of fun," he told a crowd of 3,500. "And besides it helps the [Post Office] department."

Today you would be hard pressed to find a more beautiful post office in America than the six-story Beaux Arts building Farley dedicated across the street from the Alamo. Yet if you go into the post office and buy a stamp—as Farley urged 79 years ago—you are in for an ordeal.

Just to get into the post office's ornate lobby, you have to go through a security review that surpasses what I have experienced in most federal buildings in Washington or even Dulles International Airport. I had to take off my belt, remove everything in my pockets— "Yes, everything," the guards will tell you before you pass through a metal detector.

The ground-level post office has two sets of glass doors opening directly on to Houston Street in the heart of the city's business district, but they both were locked. The building's security was clearly aimed at people who would be using the elevators to go upstairs to the federal courts or other federal offices. That function could be continued without threatening the security of the courts and other federal agencies upstairs.

I'm all for security of federal buildings, but I'm also troubled about the future of the United States Postal Service. It needs customers to survive. Lots of them. As Ruth Y. Goldway, former chairman of the Postal Regulatory Commission, once said, "… limiting access and declines in service create a self-fulfilling prophecy." The USPS is suffering from both problems: a shrinking number of postal facilities and declining service.

This once charming post office in the Hipolito F. Garcia Federal Building and U.S. Courthouse illustrates how the government's own rules are harming the Postal Service. When I asked the USPS to explain why a post office in a major city should be placed behind such formidable security, I was informed that the General Services Administration, the federal government's landlord, controlled the building.

"Building security has been established by the GSA and the Postal Service does not have the authority to change it," said spokesman David Partenheimer. USPS employees have to carry access badges issued by the GSA, and "non-employees" must pass through "security guard screening," he said. "Non-employees" appears to be how the GSA views postal customers.

"Regarding the other set of doors referenced in the inquiry, the Postal Service is not permitted to utilize those doors, due to the security guidelines put in place by GSA," Partenheimer told Linn's, citing information from his field office in Texas.

When asked if the USPS had protested these rules, Partenheimer allowed that postal officials had been so troubled by them that they had proposed closing the post office in 2011. "However, there was strong community opposition to closing this office, so we downsized the operation while maintaining a Post Office presence," he said. The USPS has received "very few, if any complaints related to the security process for entry from our customers at this location," he said.

If postal officials want confirmation of how the public is treating this security, they need only check the emptiness of the postal lobby or one of the websites that reviews businesses, such as Yelp. There they'll discover customers are voting with their feet, going elsewhere for stamps and post services.

The sales windows are open only four days a week, Monday through Thursday. "For postal customer convenience in the Downtown San Antonio area, we expanded access to postal products and services with several nearby retail outlets selling stamps at face value and with a Contract Postal Unit located in the Frost Bank Tower Building, 100 W. Sam Houston St., Suite 100, about five blocks west of the Downtown Station Post Office," Partenheimer said.

Charlie Cook, a GSA spokesman, said rules for the San Antonio building are set by a committee composed of its tenants. If the USPS wants a change, it's up to the USPS to file a request, he said.

If James Farley were still alive, I can only guess what he would think of the government making it so difficult to buy stamps.

http://www.linns.com/news/postal-updates/2016/april/buying-stamps-ordeal-san-antonio-texas-post-office.html

(Editor's note: I combined some of the paragraphs in this article in order to fit it into the space available. *Lea*)